

Basket Case -- Green Day

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

From *Dookie* (1994), ~171 BPM.

Mike Dirnt's tone here is bright, punchy pop-punk bass -- famously built on blending a clean signal with a grittier, driven layer rather than going full fuzz. The song runs at high energy throughout; the chorus ("I went to a shrink...") pushes a bit harder with the vocal harmonies.

CTL off = the driving verse. CTL on = the chorus push.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB.

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 22
- Always on. Moderate threshold -- there's real grit in this chain from the Bass OD, needs some cleanup between the fast eighth-note picking.

PRE -- Micro Boost -- On CTL

- Gain: 50
- CTL off: bypassed (verse). CTL on: engaged (chorus).
- Verse already drives hard on its own. Chorus gets a clean push to sit level with the vocal harmonies.

DST -- Bass OD

- Gain: 55, Blend: 65, VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Treble: 60
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- This is the "blended dirty" layer Dirnt's tone is known for -- Blend at 65 keeps enough clean fundamental mixed in that the tone stays punchy and defined rather than turning into a wash, while Treble pushed to 60 keeps real edge and bite on top.

AMP -- Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT)

- Gain: 45, Bass: 55, Middle: 58, MidFreq: 800Hz, Treble: 62, VOL: 68
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- SVT is a genuine punk-rock bass amp choice, not just a metal/rock default -- plenty of 90s punk and pop-punk bassists lean on that big, bright Ampeg push. Treble pushed hard here for the bright, present character this whole genre wants.

CAB -- User IR 6 (Hartke410)

- VOL: 60
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- Bright, aggressive aluminum-cone voicing -- `IRs/ir.md` calls this one out specifically for a grittier, driven bass tone, which is exactly the job here. Keeps this cutting through fast, palm-muted punk guitars instead of getting buried.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +2, 150Hz: -2, 600Hz: +2, 2kHz: +5, 8kHz: +4, VOL: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- Big +5 at 2kHz and +4 at 8kHz -- this needs to be bright and present to cut through a fast, driving punk mix.
- 2 at 150Hz keeps it from getting boxy under all that upper-mid push.

MOD -- Off

- No modulation. Straightforward, driving pop-punk tone.

DLY -- Off

- Not used.

RVB -- Room -- On CTL

- Mix: 18, Decay: 28, Trail: On
- CTL off: bypassed (verse -- tight and dry). CTL on: engaged (chorus).
- A light touch of room for the chorus, matching the slightly bigger, more anthemic feel of the vocal harmonies
- kept subtle since 90s pop-punk production stays fairly dry overall.

CAB IR -- Hartke410 (Slot 6)

- Hartke XL410 with aluminum cones, confirmed loaded on User IR slot 6. Bright, aggressive voicing suited to a driven bass tone.
- Encoded directly into the `.prst` as a real, active CAB reference (`User IR 6`) -- no manual loading needed for this one.

CTL summary

- **CTL Off -- Verse.** Driving, bright, punchy pop-punk tone.
- **CTL On -- Chorus.** Boost and room reverb engage together, matching the bigger feel of the vocal harmonies on "I went to a shrink..."
- Engage CTL right as the chorus hits, back off returning to the verse.

Full pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. This driving punk line doesn't need octave layering.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged

- COMP: 50
- TONE: 60
- LEVEL: 60
- Mode: TREBLE
- Keeps the fast eighth-note picking even and consistent. TREBLE mode keeps pick attack bright and present ahead of the Tidal Wave and the GP-5's own Bass OD.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. Dirnt's dirty layer is a blended overdrive, not a fuzz -- the GP-5's own Bass OD already covers that job with more clarity than a fuzz would give at this tempo.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Engaged

- Drive: 30
- Blend: 55
- Presence: 65
- Level: 60
- Treble: 60
- Middle: 55
- Bass: 52
- Mid-Frequency: 1000Hz
- Bass-Shift: 80Hz
- Cab-Sim (DI out): Off
- Ground Lift: Off
- Adds baseline drive and presence. Mid-Frequency at 1000Hz and Bass-Shift at 80Hz both push toward attack and articulation over body, matching this song's fast, punchy energy.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. No chorus -- matches the MOD-off call on the GP-5. Bright, direct pop-punk tone throughout.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- see settings above.